

I'm Dreading Something Coming Up

All right, so you have something on your calendar, something that you plan to do, and the dread is, is coming up. Your brain has already decided that this thing that is coming up is going to be a real problem for you. The dread is here. The what ifs are just off the charts, and I'm sure your brain at this point is mentally rehearsing everything that could go wrong, and we're not even there yet.

We are living in this future that does not exist yet. And deciding it's gonna be the worst thing that could happen. And what you'll find is the anticipation you're experiencing right now in advance is almost always worse than the thing itself. Your brain is projecting onto the future. Because if it can predict the danger and prepare you for the worst, it is helping you.

It really thinks it's helping you, but it's not. What's actually happening is you are going to end up living through this event twice if you can make it there once now and then once again when it actually happens. So here's the work here. We're not going to be fortune tellers. We're not gonna live in that future.

Stop rehearsing this outcome unless you're gonna rehearse it in a way that actually serves you. Unless you're, you're ready to start rehearsing the best case scenario, you do not need to figure out how you're going to feel when you get there or what's going to happen, or every scenario. You don't need to decide right now whether or not you're going to be okay.

You just go and you deal with what's actually there when you are actually there. So if your brain is just off the rails right now, what if I panic? What if my symptoms spike? What if I can't sit down? What if I can't stand up? What if I can't make it the whole thing? What if I can't handle it? Then that happens and you handle it then, but we're not gonna handle it now because right now it's, it's not real.

You have never been able to successfully think your way out of anticipatory anxiety. It's, it's not how it works. You can't like imagine this well enough to feel safe or know the outcome. You're trying to close a loop that cannot be closed. The only thing that's

gonna work is going anyway, feeling whatever you feel responding as best as you can, and showing your nervous system that you survived.

That is how you rewire this, not by preparing, not by avoiding the thing altogether, not by staying at home, not by shrinking your life, but by doing so, we're not gonna keep negotiating with the future. It's not here yet. If you need a reminder about reentering life before you feel a hundred percent ready, I want you to revisit lessons 12 and 13.

You don't have to feel ready, you just have to go and try to have the best time that you can.